ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

2024 ANNUAL REPORT











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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The year under review was a fairly busy one in which the Commission successfully conducted a number of activities including outstanding by-elections. The Commission was allocated **ZWL 177 705 136.50** for the 2024 financial year and consumed **ZWL 161 419 932.00** which represents **91%** of the said budget. However, the budget performed below expectation and the year ended with a deficit. The Commission also received financial support to the tune of **US$1 306 995.73** from cooperating partners under the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission Capacity Building (ZIM-ECO) Project Phase 2.

The Commission had a full complement of Commissioners and met six times in line with the provisions of the relevant law. It also recruited **18** new employees during the year under review with **67%** being female and **33%** being male.

An annual stocktake was conducted in line with the provisions of the Public Finance Management Act [*Chapter 22:19*]. The Commission also realised **USD$74 747.36** from the disposal of obsolete and unserviceable assets and a number of infrastructural maintenance projects were also undertaken in various districts during the year under review.

A new voter education tool the chatbot was also developed during the same period. A total of **9 422** voters were registered with **7 764** being successfully registered on its data base. It also conducted a stakeholder engagement conference for the purpose of reviewing the 2023 Harmonised Elections. The Commission also participated in various regional and international plebiscites and other events.

CHAIRPERSON'S FOREWORD

It is my pleasure to present the 2024 Zimbabwe Electoral Commission Annual Report in line with the provisions of Section 323 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe as read with Section 13(2) of the Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*]. The Report highlights the Commission achievements, challenges and progress toward its strategic objectives.

The year 2024 was a fairly busy one marked by a number of parliamentary and local authority by-elections, a majority of which were occasioned by internal recalls of membership, deaths and resignations within and from certain political stakeholders. The Commission remained committed to adhering to constitutional requirements and fulfilling stakeholder demands.

Similarly, the international scene was also characterised by a number of electoral activities during the year under review. The Southern African Development Community (SADC) region alone witnessed a busy election calendar with at least seven countries conducting elections. The Commission was able to send representation to election observation missions of at least four (4) countries of the region namely Botswana, Mozambique, Namibia and South Africa under the Electoral Commission Forum of SADC (ECF-SADC) countries. The Commission had the privilege of leading the ECF-SADC delegation for the Namibian General and Parliamentary Elections. Apart from observing elections in the SADC region, the Commission also participated in various other continent-wide plebiscites and international meetings and conferences.

However, on a sad note, the Commission wishes to advise that after more than **17** years of remarkable service with the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission, Mr Utloile Silaigwana is proceeding on another assignment leaving behind a legacy of commitment and unwavering dedication. As he embarks on a new chapter, the Commission wishes to express its deepest gratitude for his remarkable service, leadership and contributions to both the organisation and the country. The Commission celebrates his achievements, honours his legacy and wishes him all the best in his future endeavours.

This report showcases the Commission's efforts to conduct electoral processes effectively and to enhance accountability and transparency in line with its constitutional obligations. The Commission is proud of its continued commitment to the conduct of credible electoral processes and is optimistic that this will enable it to contribute to conducive and peaceful environments that drive growth, innovation and positive impact to our beloved country.

Let me conclude by extending the Commission's gratitude to all board members, Secretariat staff and stakeholders. Special mention also goes to the UNDP and all cooperating partners for the support received by the Commission under the ZIM-ECO 2 Project. Sadly, the project terminated on the 31st of December 2024 and the Commission hopes to renew the relationship in the near future.

CHIEF ELECTIONS OFFICER'S REMARKS

As I reflect on 2024, I am proud of the progress we have made in achieving the Commission's objectives. With each passing year, our team continues to demonstrate reasonable resilience, adaptability and commitment to duty. The past year as already alluded to by the Chairperson was a fairly busy one given the numerous calls to duty occasioned by the emerging vacancies in both Parliament and local authorities.

The successful discharge of both constitutional and statutory obligations not only demonstrates our ability to execute on our strategy but also underscores our dedication to the Commission's mission. As the foot soldiers of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission, we remain focussed on delivering world class service to our stakeholders. We are committed to the upholding of constitutional values through professional delivery of electoral service. However, as already indicated, this report is my last one as the Chief Elections Officer of the organisation having been nominated for another national duty with effect from the next financial year. As I leave the organisation, it is my wish that elections are considered as a project that has a cycle, the pre-election, election and post-election whose phases are financed accordingly to avoid a situation where they are considered as an event and resources are disbursed towards their conduct.

I wish to express my deepest gratitude to all stakeholders for providing me with the opportunity to lead this important organisation in the matrix of democracy. Indeed, it was a privilege and an honour to lead the Secretariat even in the face of adversity at times. Such an honour will forever be cherished and I wish those remaining in service the best in all future missions. A special thanks goes to all serving and previous Zimbabwe Electoral Commission board members and all stakeholders for the unwavering trust and support during my tenure of service.

Please join the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission in reviewing this Annual Report, which provides an overview of our progress, achievements and financial performance.

VISION

A centre of excellence in the management of elections and referendums

MISSION

To conduct credible elections and referendums in Zimbabwe

VALUES

- Transparency
- Independence
- Teamwork
- Impartiality
- Integrity
- Inclusivity

Overall Functions of the Commission (Section 239 of the Constitution)

a. To prepare for, conduct and supervise—

(i) Elections to the office of the President and to Parliament;

(ii) Elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities:

(iii) Elections of members of the National Council of Chiefs; and

(iv) Referendums, and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with law;

b. To supervise elections of the President of Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that those elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. To register voters;

d. To compile voter's roll and registers;

e. To ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voter's roll and registers;

f. To delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. To design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. To conduct and supervise voter education;

i. To accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. To give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purposes of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. To receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

Additional functions of the Commission (Section 5 of the Electoral Act [Chapter 2:13])

In addition to the functions set out in section 239 of the Constitution, the Commission is responsible for:

- Undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters: and
- Developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to electoral processes;and
- Promoting co-operation between the Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and
- Keeping the public informed about the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise, and
- The delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries; and
- The location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open; and
- Voters' roll and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and
- Political parties and candidates contesting every election; and
- Voting; and
- Generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and
- Ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and
- Making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

Commission Governance

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe. It consists of a Chairperson, who, by operation of the law, should be a Judge or former Judge or a person qualified to be appointed as such, appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders, and eight other members, appointed by the President from a list of nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders. During the year under review, the following were members of the Commission: -



Hon. Justice P. M Chigumba: Chairperson



Amb. R. S. Kiwa: Deputy Chairperson



Comm. A. M. M Ambrose



Comm. J Mangwana



Comm. S Manhivi



Comm. R. Murutare



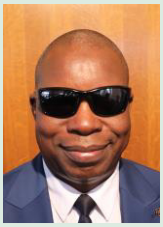
Comm. C. Mpofu



Comm. Dr J. M Nzvenga



Mr. U. Silaigwana: CEO



Comm. Dr K. Shava

Commission Staff

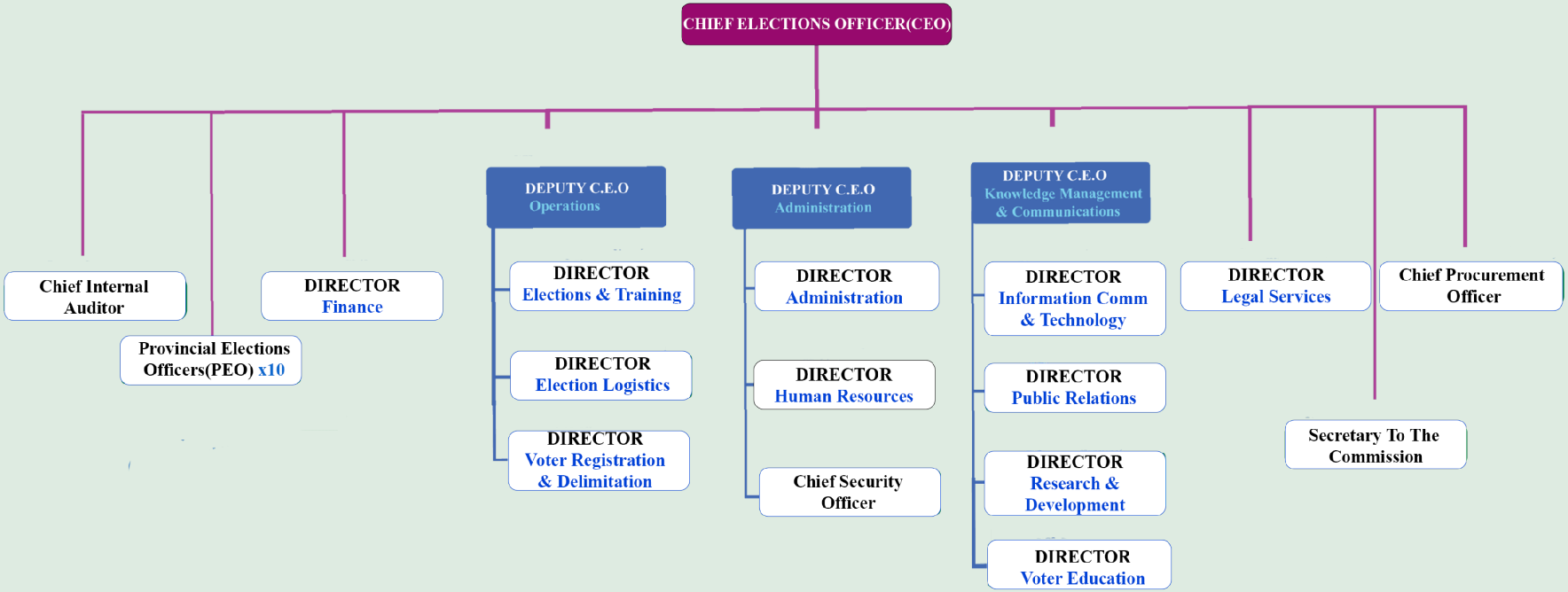
The Commission is serviced by a full time Secretariat headed by the Chief Elections Officer. It is empowered by the Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] to employ other staff in addition to the Chief Elections Officer. The Secretariat comprises full time employees in the following Divisions:

(i) Operations;

(ii) Administration; and

(iii) Knowledge Management and Communication

These Divisions are replicated, albeit at smaller scale, at Provincial and District levels. Under these divisions are various Departments, each dealing with specific issues such as Elections and Training, Voter Education, Voter Registration and Delimitation, Election Logistics, Administration, Human Resources, Information and Communication Technology, Finance, and Research and Development, Public Relations. The Commission also has Legal, Procurement, Internal Audit and Security which offer support to the institutions. The Commission is decentralized into **10** Provinces and **68** Districts.


CHIEF ELECTIONS OFFICER(CEO)
Chief Internal Auditor
Provincial Elections Officers(PEO) x10
DIRECTOR Finance
DEPUTY C.E.O Operations
DIRECTOR Elections & Training
DIRECTOR Election Logistics
DIRECTOR Voter Registration & Delimitation
DEPUTY C.E.O Administration
DIRECTOR Administration
DIRECTOR Human Resources
Chief Security Officer
DEPUTY C.E.O Knowledge Management & Communications
DIRECTOR Information Comm & Technology
DIRECTOR Public Relations
DIRECTOR Research & Development
DIRECTOR Voter Education
DIRECTOR Legal Services
Chief Procurement Officer
Secretary To The Commission

THE COMMISSION'S PROGRAMMES

The Commission has two Programmes in line with Programme Based Budgeting (PBB).
Each Programme has sub-programmes as below:

Programme 1: Governance and Administration

Strategic Goal: Improved corporate governance and effective administration

Sub-Programmes:

1. Commission and Chief Executive Office
2. Finance
3. Human Resources
4. Administration
5. Audit, Security and Legal
6. ICT, Public Relations and Knowledge Management
7. Provinces and Districts

Programme 2: Election Management

Strategic Goal: Increased public confidence in Electoral processes.

Sub-Programmes

1. Voter Registration and Delimitation
2. Polling

FINANCE

Budget Performance

The Commission was allocated **ZWG177 705 136.56** by Parliament for the 2024 financial year in line with the provisions of section 305 (1) of the Constitution as read with section 28 of the Public Finance Management Act [*Chapter 22:19*] to support the execution of its mandate. The budget consumption for the year under review amounted to **ZWG161 419 932.00** which represents 91% of the annual budget. The consumed budget excludes the accrued expenditure of **ZWG75 million** thus indicating that overall, the budget performed below expectation and the year ended with a deficit.

During the same financial period, the Commission received financial support from cooperating partners to the tune of **US$1 306 995.73** through the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission Capacity Building (ZIM-ECO) Project Phase2 under four pillars namely; Effectiveness, Accountability, Inclusion, and Peace and Justice.

The support from both the government and cooperating partners enabled the Commission to achieve a number of its objectives as will more fully appear in this report.

However, despite these achievements, the Commission also experienced some challenges in the implementation of the allocated budget. The financial year was characterised by inflationary pressures culminating from negative fluctuations of the exchange rate. This rendered the budget insufficient to match the prevailing pricing levels of most suppliers since these were pegged against the exchange rate of the day. This resulted in the accumulation of outstanding bills amounting to **ZWG75 million** from various service providers.

The inconsistency in budgetary support by Treasury during elections led to delayed funding in some cases, resulting in election officials being deployed for election duties without being paid their subsistence allowances. In addition, this delayed the procurement of election materials and other services or caused the non- procurement at all of some services owing to limited timelines.

Further, the budget allocation was not adequate to support the acquisition or construction of appropriate office or storage space. The Commission had and still has serious accommodation challenges which expose both the assets and staff to unfavourable conditions. Some election material was lost during the year under review owing to the poor state of some storage facilities.

There is need to adequately ensure that sufficient funds are appropriated and released on time to guarantee uncompromised service delivery by the Commission. Elections are not an event but a process hence it is important that funding unswervingly follows the electoral cycle, that is, the pre-election, election and post-election periods. Office accommodation also needs to be prioritised to take care of staff needs and to avoid the risk of losing assets including high value ones through exposure to unfavourable storage conditions, pilferage and other vices.

PROGRAMME 1 ACTIVITIES

Corporate Governance Issues
Meetings of the Commission

Clause 1 of the Sixth Schedule to the Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] provides that the Commission must meet a minimum six times during any given year.

During the year under review, the Commission met six times in line with the said legal requirement.

However, three of the meetings were held virtually owing to non-availability of resources to conduct physical meetings.

Committee Meetings

The Commission has seven Committees which assist it in the discharge of its business by providing a structured approach to its decision making, problem solving and oversight. These are namely, Finance, Legal, Public Relations, Audit and Risk, Voter Education and Voter Registration and Delimitation, Research and Gender and the Administration and Human Resources. These Committees met prior to the main Commission meetings in line with good corporate governance tenets.

Corporate Governance Training

A corporate governance training workshop was conducted for its members and senior Secretariat staff between the 9th and 11th of October 2024. The specific objective of the workshop was to apprise them of their roles, duties and functions on corporate governance related issues as well as on the operational and administrative responsibilities. An external consultant was hired to facilitate the said workshop.

Statutory Obligations

Submission of Statutory Reports

Sections 241 and 323 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe as read with sections 13(1) and (2) of the Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] require the Commission to submit election and annual reports to Parliament within the periods specified therein. The Commission fully complied with the provisions of the said law.

Facilitation of Electoral Processes

Sections 40I and 160B respectively of the Electoral Act also enjoin the Commission to establish statutory Committees for purposes of accreditation of election observers and multi-party liaison committees for the resolution of electoral disputes. These Committees were established during the by-elections held in the year under review.

HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT

ZEC Secretariat Staff Establishment

ZEC has an establishment of **680** posts. Of these, **526** posts are filled. This is **28** posts less than those reported during the previous financial year. In addition, there are **58** ZRP Special Constabularies seconded to ZEC.

Staff Profile

Age Groups

Table below shows the age profile for the Secretariat staff:-

AGE GROUP	MALES	FEMALES	TOTALS	
			Number	%age
18-19	0	0	0	0
20-24	0	6	6	1.14%
25-29	25	22	47	8.92%
30-34	39	44	83	15.75%
35-39	25	25	50	9.49%
40-44	31	45	76	14.42%
45-49	40	40	80	15.18%
50-54	46	30	76	14.42%
55-59	33	17	50	9.49%
60-64	39	19	58	11.20%
65-69	0	0	0	0
70+	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	**278**	**248**	**526**	**100%**

Gender

32% of ZEC Top Management (i.e. Grade 1 to Grade 3a) are women and overall **47%** of ZEC employees are women.

Posts Authorized for Filling

During the year under review, the Commission received concurrence from Treasury to fill only one post of Personal Aide.

Appointments

The Commission also recruited **18** new employees as tabulated below. Of those recruited **67%** were female while **33%** were male.

	Grade	**Number**	**Station**
1.	3	1	Head Office
2.	8	9	Head Office x 2 Provinces x 5 Districts x 2
3.	10	7	Provinces x 1 Districts x 6
4.	12	1	Head Office x 1
	Total	**18**	

Re-gradings /Promotions

There were a number of internal regrading/promotions to fill vacant posts that were created through natural attrition. All the posts were filled after following due procedure.

In all, **34** employees were re-graded and promoted during the year as tabulated below: -

Ser.	**New Grade**	**Number**
1.	3	2
2.	3a	3
3.	4	1
4.	5	12
5.	6	3
6.	7	1
7.	8	7
8.	10	3
9.	12	2
	Total	**34**

Terminations

A total of **26** employees terminated employment with the Commission as tabulated below**.**

	Reason	**Number**	**Grade**
1.	Discharge	3	Grade 4 x 2 Grade 6 x 1
2.	Resignation	10	Grade 3 x 1 Grade 7 x 1 Grade 8 x 5 Grade 10 x 1 Grade 13 x 2
3.	Retirement	9	Grade 1x1 Grade 3 x 1 Grade 5 x 3 Grade 6 x 2 Grade 10 x 1 Grade 12 x 1
4.	Transfer to other Govt. Dept.	3	Grade 6 x 1 Grade 8 x 2
5.	End of Contract	1	Grade 11 x 1
	Totals	**26**	

Therefore, the staff attrition rate was **5%** as at 31 December 2024.

Training

A total of 14 training Programmes /Workshops were held during 2024**.** Most of the programmes were funded under the ZIM-ECO project.

Performance Management
ZEC employees prepared their annual workplans for 2024. Performance Reviews were carried out for the three-quarters of the year and performance appraisals were completed.

ADMINISTRATION

Procurement Management

The Commission managed to purchase provisions, materials and assets, marshal transport, arrange local and foreign business undertakings, distribute materials, move correspondences, and identify buildings for office accommodation and ensure a sound general administration for all its offices.

The Commission also ensured that all important procurements were made for all the by-elections that took place during the year under review, including for election material and fuel. Below is a list of some important high value tenders awarded in 2024.

Tenders Awarded in 2024

SER	NAME OF TENDER
1	Supply and delivery of Acetone
2	Supply and delivery of Pathway data
3	Insurance of motor Vehicles
4	Supply and delivery of 36-seater bus
5	Supply and delivery of Sophos Licence renewal
6	Supply and delivery of ZITF Stand Design
7	Supply and delivery of elevator service
8	Supply, installation and configuration of LANs and WANs.
9	Data centre maintenance
10	Ballot paper and voters' roll Printing
11	Refurbishment, repairs of Commission's ZAS pavillion

Tender documents were prepared and floated into the public market and all purchased items were delivered, inspected, received, stored and distributed to users in line with laid down procedure.

All informal tenders were advertised through the E- Government Procurement system in order to broaden the selection of potential suppliers.

However, the late payment or non-payment for some suppliers after delivery affected the supply chain and ZEC/Supplier relationships. This caused some challenges on the Commission as some suppliers resorted to requesting contract price variations after payment putting pressure on the limited budgetary support from Treasury.

Transport Management

ZEC Fleet

SER	Vehicle Type	Total Number
1	Light vehicles (Toyota Prados, Isuzu DMAX, Nissan NP300, Nissan Navara and Ford Rangers)	175
2	Heavy vehicles (Staff Bus)	1
3	Motor bikes	124

The vehicles are deployed across the country from Head Office down to the District level. Most of the vehicles were purchased in 2017. The life of the 2017 fleet has now come to an end and this is causing constant break downs and increasing the cost of maintaining the fleet.

The entire 2017 fleet needs replacement to ensure the efficient conduct of future elections. There has been some inconsistence in maintaining the service schedule of motor vehicles owing to financial constraints.

Disposal of Obsolete/Unserviceable Assets

The Commission made some progress in disposing unserviceable and obsolete assets. On the 7th of June 2024, the Commission managed to dispose various assets (vehicles, computer equipment and furniture) through public auction conducted by Hammer and Tongues.

The net proceeds realised are as follows:

SER	ITEM DISPOSED	AMOUNT REALISED
1	Motor Vehicles	USD40,266.80
2	Other Equipment	USD34,480.56
	Total	USD74,747.36

Stocktake and Asset Verification Exercise

The Commission conducted an annual stock-take in terms of Public Finance Management Act [*Chapter 22:19*]. ZEC does not have warehouses of its own. Most of the election materials and equipment are stored in borrowed or rented warehouses that are small and inadequate. In some cases, some election materials are kept in pitched tents leaving the materials to the vagaries of bad weather.

Infrastructural Development and Maintenance



Prefabricated ZEC Toilet and Office in the Background in Tsholotsho District

Three infrastructural maintenance projects were carried out during the period under review. Prefabricated toilets were constructed in Mazowe, Marondera and Tsholotsho Districts. The Commission also repainted its offices in Bulawayo Metropolitan Province using rental proceeds from the same building in order to enhance its image. It also purchased office accommodation for the Gokwe North district. Processing of change of ownership of the purchased property was underway by the end of the year under review.

The Commission was also allocated a stand by the Matobo Rural District Council. A tender for the construction of a prefabricated office at the stand had already been awarded. Construction had been earmarked for the first quarter of the next financial year.

Overall, construction of own Commission warehouses remains a top priority for safeguarding high value assets and inventory in its possession and that required for future holding of elections. These warehouses need to be insured because of the value of assets they hold.

INTERNAL AUDIT

The Commission compiled the mandatory annual risk-based internal audit plan. The plan included six head office audits, four provincial audits, five follow-up assignments, special investigations, and participation in the annual stock-take and asset verification exercise and these were executed as follows:

- conducted five audits out of six primarily focusing on by-elections, for which partial funding was received from Treasury.
- conducted audits on records management and fuel management at Head Office.

Throughout the year, the Commission fully adopted the Risk-Based Internal Audit Approach in executing the audit work. However, full implementation of the planned audit work was not achieved due to financial constraints.

Due Diligence Review

Price due diligence reviews and value-for-money evaluations on all payments and contracts undertaken by the Commission were carried out in 2024. To support this effort, some internal audit staff were assigned full-time to the due diligence desk on a daily basis.

Training and Workshops

During the year under review, the Commission deployed some of its internal audit staff to attend several professional development workshops which included SAP training hosted by the Ministry of Finance, Economic Development and Investment Promotion and an introductory course on IPSAS basic concepts conducted by ICAZ consultants. However, due to resource constraints, the Commission only managed to send a limited number of auditors for SAP training, with the remaining staff members still to undergo similar training. Three of the Commission's internal auditors successfully completed and passed the IPSAS introductory examinations. In addition, the Ministry of Finance, Economic Development and Investment Promotion also allocated SAP internal audit profiles to the entire internal audit staff in the third quarter of 2024.

LEGAL

Litigation

The Commission received a number of legal suits against it during the period under review and some were matters carried over from the previous year which have not yet been concluded.
The table below indicates the cases that were brought forward from previous years and those brought before the courts in the year 2024.

ZEC CASE SCHEDULE FOR 2023 - 2024

	PARTIES	**CASE NO:**	**STATUS**
1	Douglas Mwonzora: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ09/23	Granted
2	Douglas Mwonzora: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ20/23	Dismissed
3	Allan Norman Markham: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC 183/23	Struck of the roll
5	Jeremiah Bamu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ 23/23	Granted
6	Douglas Mwonzora: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 3207/23	Dismissed
7	Douglas Mwonzora: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 3366/23	Withdrawn
8	Egypt Dzinemhunhenzva: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 3977/23	Struck of the Roll
9	Dominic Matangira: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 4034/23	Withdrawn
	PETITIONS FROM 22/06/23		
10	Linda Tsungirirai Masarira: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ 28/23	Dismissed
11	Citizens coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC06/23	Withdrawn
12	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Election Commission	BEC13/23	Withdrawn by consent
13	Aquilina K. Pamberi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC02/23	Withdrawn
14	Citizens Coalition for Change: Electoral Commission	BEC11/23	Struck off the roll
15	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC05/23	Dismissed
16	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC03/23	Dismissed
17	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC 04/23	Dismissed

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
18	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 03/23	Dismissed
19	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 04/23	Dismissed
20	Movement for Democratic Change -T: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 05/23	Struck off the roll
21	Epiphenia Munhunepi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission:	HC 4145/23	Dismissed
22	Casper Muzhona: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 07/23	Dismissed
23	Denias Bako: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 06/23	Dismissed
24	Elisabeth Isabel Valerio: Zimbabwe Commission	EC 02/23	Judgment reserved
25	Shadreck Makombe: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 08/23	Struck Off HH473-23
26	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC 12/23	Allowed
27	Labour, Economists and African Democrats Party: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 4146/23	Dismissed
28	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCC139/23	Dismissed
29	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC15/23	Struck off HH155-23
30	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC16/23	Struck off HH155-23
31	Marvelous Muyezi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC10/23	Abandoned by consent
32	Lovemore Magaya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC 8/23	Abandoned by Consent
33	Kaserera Alec: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC 3/23	Dismissed
34	Takwana Mavhurere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	B EC9/23	Abandoned by Consent
35	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC11/23	Struck off HH155/23
36	Collin Chirume: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M EC05/23	Dismissed
37	Marvelous S. Beston: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M EC07/23	Dismissed
38	Lyton Magwizi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC07/23	Abandoned by Consent
39	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC13/23	Withdrawn by Consent
40	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC 14/23	Struck off HH155-23

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
41	Rice Mahambe: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M EC08/23	Dismissed
42	Saul Chinyamujiko: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M EC 06/23	Dismissed
43	Somebody Muchacha: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M EC01/23	Dismissed
44	Yotam Jacob: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M 02/23	Dismissed
45	Shadreck Makombe: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	MEC 08/23	Dismissed
46	Lovedale Mangwana: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC10/23	Dismissed
47	Aquilina K. Pamberi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCB1333/23	Dismissed *HB155/23
48	Tawanda Kadozora: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	M EC04/23	Dismissed
49	Cherita Mundoka: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	MAS EC04/23	Granted
50	Brian Kakurira: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C140/23	Dismissed
51	Gift Runozivei: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C141/23	Dismissed
52	Augustine Nkomo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C142/23	Dismissed
53	Norman Ngundu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C143/23	Dismissed
54	Edwin Mudzviti: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C144/23	Dismissed
55	Sidney Denga: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C 145/23	Dismissed
56	Chadamoyo Mapuranga: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C146/23	Dismissed
57	Chamunorwa Maunga: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C147/23	Dismissed
58	Batsirai Chongo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C148/23	Dismissed
59	Abraham Cheteni: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C149/23	Dismissed
60	Canfred Munhungeyi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C150/23	Dismissed
61	Shackem Madhaka: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C151/23	Dismissed
62	Stephen Bwanali: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC C152/23	Dismissed
63	Tatenda Madzirashe: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1357/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
64	Sandra Dube: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1358/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
65	Gloria Dube: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1359/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
66	Linda Mpofu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1360/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
67	Mayibonwinkosi Nkomo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1361/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
68	Rachel Dube: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1362/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
69	Hardlife Ndlovu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1363/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
70	Marshal Nkomo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1364/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
71	Hellen Moyo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1365/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
72	Panashe Gleyn Machekano: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1366/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
73	Ashley Letters Moyo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1367/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
74	Ransom Junior Chingwara: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1368/23	Granted but later overturned on Appeal
75	Movement for Democratic Change-Tsvangirai: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 11/23	Dismissed
76	Movement for Democratic Change – Tsvangirai: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 12/23	Dismissed
77	Siboneni Mpofu: Zimbabwe electoral Commission	EC 13/23	Dismissed
78	Khulasizwe Consultancy (Pvt) Ltd T/A Asakhe Online: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1417/23	Dismissed
79	Dereck Kossam: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BEC1/23	Dismissed
80	Saviour Kasukuwere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC 387/23	Dismissed

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
81	Lovedale Mangwana: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC 396/23	Granted
82	Lovedale Mangwana: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 4701/23	Removed from roll pending SC appeal
83	Mercy Mazadza: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1465/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
84	Courage Guchu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1466/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
85	Hazel S. Moyo: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1467/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
86	Tsitsi Dzete: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1468/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
87	Liponia Tshuma: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1469/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
88	Diana S. Ncube: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1470/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
89	Sheila Mafu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1471/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
90	Emily Handina: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1472/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
91	Nomazulu Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1473/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
92	Innocent Gotami: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1474/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
93	Patrick Shereni: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1475/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
94	Netsai Kawome: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1476/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
95	Nomazulu Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC 1473/23	Granted in High Court but decision overturned on Appeal
96	Lawrence Mharadzirwa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 4754/23	Dismissed
97	Jim Kunaka: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ 34/23	Withdrawn
98	Bajila Collins Discent: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB59/23	Allowed
99	Frank Mhlanga: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB60/23	Allowed
100	Adelaide Mhlanga: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB61/23	Allowed
101	Saviour Kasukuwere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ35/23	Dismissed
102	Saviour Kasukuwere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ36/23	Withdrawn
103	Sanpoulas Maplanka: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB62/23	Allowed
104	Raymond Dzudzayi Gombedza: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	BHC1601/23	Withdrawn
105	Mandlenkosi Dube: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 15/13	Withdrawn
106	Langton Chingwendere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 16/23	Withdrawn
107	Blessing Chitauro: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 17/23	Withdrawn
108	Brighton Mazhindu: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 5139/23	Withdrawn
109	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC 453/23	Dismissed
110	Ancelimo Magaya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 5182/23	Struck of the roll
111	Saviour Kasukuwere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 18/23	Dismissed

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
112	Jim Kunaka: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ 37/23	Dismissed
113	Saviour Kasukuwere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ 39/23	Dismissed
114	Saviour Kasukuwere: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ 40/23	Dismissed
115	Lameck Zhanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 22/23	Withdrawn
116	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB64/23	Withdrawn
117	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 23/23	Removed from the roll
118	Musa Kika: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 24/23	Struck off
119	Arnold Tsunga: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 25/23	Struck off
120	Ancelimo Muzvondiwa Magaya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 26/23	Struck off
121	Young Journalists' Association of Zimbabwe (YOJA): Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 27/23	Dismissed
122	Rashid Mahiya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 28/23	Struck Off
123	Abammeli: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	EC 30/23	Withdrawn
	POST ELECTIONS		
124	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB68/23	Dismissed
125	Nasper Manyau: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HC 5986/23	Struck off the roll
126	Francis Mukwangwariwa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCHEC 35/23	Removed from the roll
127	Ncube One: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBEC 32/23	Withdrawn
128	Leopold Mudisi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCMSEC 7/23	Dismissed
129	Munyaradzi Tobias Kashambe: Tapfumanei Willard Madzimbamuto	DRAFTHCHEC 3/23 (EC34/23)	Dismissed
130	Prince Dubeko Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH 6649/23	Dismissed
131	Vengai Mubango: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCMSC520/23	Struck off the roll
132	Vengai Mubango: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCMSC538/23	Dismissed
133	Prince Dubeko Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC613/23	Withdrawn
134	Prince Dubeko Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC631/23	Dismissed
135	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBEC34/23	Dismissed

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
136	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH7671/23	Removed from the roll
137	Munyaradzi Febion Kufahakutizwi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH7672/23	Withdrawn
138	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH7543/23	Granted
139	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH7804/23	Granted
140	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCMTC466/23	Dismissed
141	Ninion Varandeni: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH7941/23	Removed from the roll
142	Prince Dubeko Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC673/23	Granted
143	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCMSC631/23	Dismissed
144	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH7907/23	Granted
145	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBC2416/23	Dismissed
146	Febion M. Kufahakutizwi: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH8034/23	Withdrawn
147	Prince Dubeko Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC679/23	Withdrawn
148	Alice Kundhlande: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH8045/23	Removed from the roll
149	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH8072/23	Granted
150	Stephen Chagwiza: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCHEC37/23	Withdrawn
151	Prince Dubeko Sibanda: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC688/23	Abandoned
152	The Trustees of the Election Resource Centre Trust (ERC): Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH8220/23	Pending
153	Stephen Chagwiza: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH8293/23	Withdrawn
154	Berias Brian Trust Mari: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ1/24	Dismissed
155	Emmanuel Chikaponya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH147/24	Dismissed
156	Stephen Chagwiza: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH153/24	Dismissed

	PARTIES	CASE NO:	STATUS
157	Christopher Njiwa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCHEC1/24	Granted
158	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Change	HCH197/24	Granted
159	Amos Chibaya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC44/24	No record was submitted
160	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH654/24	Granted
161	Citizens Coalition for Change: Febion Munyaradzi Kufahakutizwi	HCH443/24	Dismissed
162	Kidwell Mujuru: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBC458/24	Granted
163	Constance Chihota: Sengezo Tshabangu	HCBC488/24	Granted
164	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH1712/24	Dismissed
165	Zimbabwe Electoral Commission: Chiriga Ballot Paper Procurement		Ongoing
166	Zimbabwe Electoral Commission : Ancelimo Magaya	HCH2990/24	Pending
167	Combined Harare Residents Association & A Markham : Zimbabwe Electoral commission	HCH3241/24	Pending
168	Ackim Muterera : Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBC1303/24	Granted
169	Lawrence Mharadzirwa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH4582/24	Dismissed
170	E Mambume : Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB132/24	Dismissed
171	Tonderai Mutasa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBEC01/24	withdrawn
172	Minister of Justice: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH5254/24	Pending
173	SM Goneso: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission		Pending
174	Preston T Paradzayi : Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH1052/25	Granted

CASES SCHEDULE FOR 2024

	PARTIES	CASE No.	STATUS
1.	Berias Brian Trust Mari: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	CCZ1/24	Dismissed
2.	Emmanuel Chikaponya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH147/24	Dismissed

3.	Christopher Njiwa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCHEC1/24	Granted
4.	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Change	HCH197/24	Granted
5.	Amos Chibaya: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SC44/24	No record was submitted
6.	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH654/24	Granted
7.	Citizens Coalition for Change: Febion Munyaradzi Kufahakutizwi	HCH443/24	Dismissed
8.	Kidwell Mujuru: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBC458/24	Granted
9.	Constance Chihota: Sengezo Tshabangu	HCBC488/24	Granted
10.	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH1579/24	
11.	Citizens Coalition for Change: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH1712/24	Dismissed
12.	Zimbabwe Electoral Commission : Ancelimo Magaya	HCH2990/24	Pending
13.	Combined Harare Residents Association & A Markham : Zimbabwe Electoral commission	HCH3241/24	Pending
14.	Ackim Muterera : Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBC1303/24	Granted
15.	Lawrence Mharadzikwa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH4582/24	Dismissed (Labour matter)
16.	E Mambume : Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	SCB132/24	Dismissed
17.	Tonderai Mutasa: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCBEC01/24	withdrawn
18.	Minister of Justice: Zimbabwe Electoral Commission	HCH5254/24	Pending

Proposals for Amendment to Electoral Law

The Commission submitted some proposals for amendment to the electoral law to the Ministry of Justice, Legal and Parliamentary Affairs. It is hoped that these proposals will be considered in the 2025 financial year.

INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY

The volume of work required from the ICT team continued to grow owing to the constant changes in technological developments. The team diligently carried out all technical and support services necessary to ensure that the organization's operations ran smoothly and efficiently. There is need for recruitment of additional staff in order to cope with increased demand for services.

ICT Policy Review and Update

During the year under review, the Commission undertook a comprehensive review of its ICT policy to align it with evolving technological advancements and organizational needs. The revised policy emphasized on enhanced security, efficient resource utilization, and streamlined ICT governance to support its mandate effectively. This revision was in alignment with the Cyber and Data Protection Act of 2022. The updated policy marked a significant step towards ensuring a robust and secure ICT framework for its operations.

ICT Infrastructure

The ICT infrastructure was well-maintained in line with established standards and procedures. Preventative maintenance was conducted as and when it was necessary.

The Commission also successfully routed all SAP traffic within the ZEC network to enable access across all provincial sites with the exception of Manicaland, Harare and Mashonaland East, which are connected physically via other Ministries on the same premises. This achievement ensured efficient access to the Public Finance Management System (PFMS) network at the provincial level. Configurations were also implemented to connect users from the Administration, Finance and Audit departments to the PFMS network.

Asset Management System Development

The Commission was in the process of developing an inventory management system for election materials during the year under review. Approximately **90%** of the development work had been completed with the system awaiting presentation to the user department for final assessment and feedback. The system will go a long way in the management of numerous election materials such as tents, polling booths, ballot boxes and Biometric Voter Registration (BVR) kits among other items.

PUBLIC RELATIONS

Stakeholder Engagement



Some Representatives of Political Parties and CSOs at the Conference

The Commission successfully conducted the 2023 Harmonised Elections Review conference at Troutbeck Resort in Nyanga during the third quarter of 2024.

The purpose of the conference was to establish what worked well and what did not in the 2023 Harmonised Elections with the objective of improving on the conduct of future elections.

About **150** people attended the conference and these included Government Ministries and Departments, Civil Society Organisations; Faith based organisations, political parties, the media, traditional leaders, diplomats and the ECF- SADC, a regional electoral body.

The conference came up with several recommendations for consideration and possible incorporation during the 2024 to 2028 electoral cycle.

Exhibitions

The Commission exhibited at both the 2024 editions of the Zimbabwe International Trade Fair and the Zimbabwe Agricultural Show. The Commission's theme for the 2024 Zimbabwe International Trade Fair was **"Electoral Sovereignty: Nurturing Industrialisation and Trade"** while that for the Zimbabwe Agricultural Show was '**Continuous Electoral Advancement for Peace and Economic Development'.**



The ZEC Pavilion at ZAS During the 2024 Exhibition

For the first time, the Commission displayed an abridged version of its Client Service Charter in video format at the Zimbabwe Agricultural Show.

Provincial Shows

During the year under review, the Commission was unable to exhibit at Provincial Agricultural Shows across all provinces due to budgetary constraints. However, in some provinces, the Commission took advantage of national and district events to exhibit its activities and wares

	Province	**Event**
1.	Mashonaland Central	National Disability Expo (Bindura)
2.	Manicaland	1. Provincial Independence Celebrations (Murambinda) 2. Day of the African Child Commemorations (Makoni)
3.	Midlands	1. District Expos (Kwekwe and Zvishavane) 2. Dadaya Career Guidance Day (Masvingo) 3. National Tree Planting Day Ceremony (Mvuma)

Media Liaison

A total of eight responses, in the form of press statements and press releases, were released for the general public through ZEC social media platforms and newspapers during the year under review.

Radio and TV Publicity Programmes

The Commission also broadcast a total of **294** weekly radio publicity programmes on Classic 263, Breeze FM, YaFM, Diamond FM, Hevoi FM, Platinum FM, Radio Zimbabwe and **14** community radio stations during the year 2024.

The **14** community radio stations are namely:

- Chimanimani FM - Chimanimani
- Wemuganga Fm - Chipinge
- Garahwa FM- Chipinge
- Nyangani FM – Nyanga
- Madziwa FM – Madziwa
- Kasambabezi FM - Kariba
- Twasumpuka FM – Binga
- Lyeja FM – Hwange
- Ingqanga FM – Bulawayo
- Radio Bukalanga – Plumtree
- Bayethe FM – Bulilima
- Intepe Manama FM – Gwanda
- Beitbridge Shashe FM – Beitbridge
- Avuxeni FM - Chiredzi

Social Media Platforms

The Commission runs a website, Facebook and X accounts. The website remains one of the Commission`s institutional memory platforms. By year end, the number of **X** followers had risen to **277 600** from **263 400** recorded in 2023. The number of followers on the Commission's Facebook page remained static at **34 000.**

Notification by new Political Parties

The Commission received and acknowledged **12** notifications from new political parties. This brought the total number of political parties on its database to **222** by year end.

INTERNATIONAL LIAISON

The Commission is a member of the Electoral Commission's Forum of SADC countries and during the period under review it attended meetings and conferences organized by the ECF-SADC. The year 2024 was a busy election year for countries in the SADC region and abroad with seven countries in the region conducting general elections. The Commission was part of various observer missions in the region and abroad as a part of a peer learning initiative. The Commission had opportunity to lead the ECF-SADC Observer Mission to Namibia during elections in that country.

PROGRAMME 2 ACTIVITIES

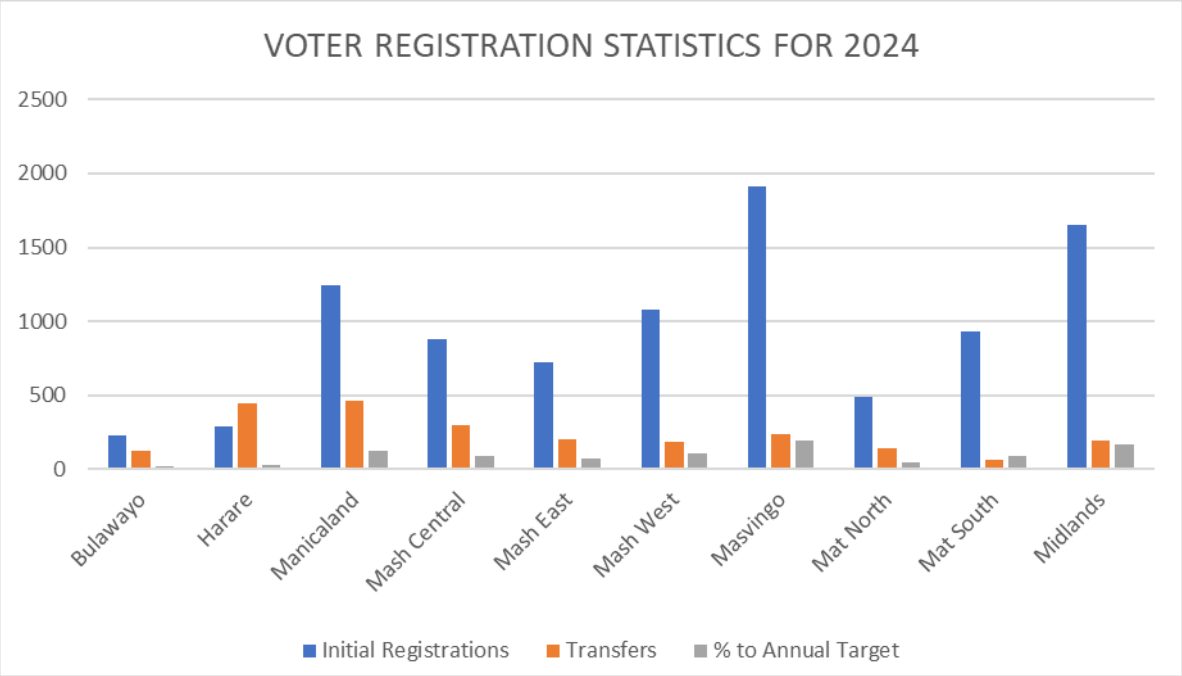
Voter Registration



Voter Registration at the 2024 ZAS Exhibition

Voter registration denotes the collection of data from all eligible citizens of the country in order to come up with a register of voters (voters' roll) to be used during elections or referenda. For the year under review, the Commission set to achieve a target of **10 000** new registrants. A mini outreach voter registration programme was conducted in the second quarter of the year after an insignificant number of registrants was recorded during the first quarter at all the provincial and district registration centres across the country. The mini outreach programme resulted in an increased voter registration turn out which reached its peak in the month of July 2024 and part of the month of August 2024 when it ended. Below are the statistics for the year under review.

PROVINCE	REGISTRANTS(VR1)			VR3 FORMS(TRANSFERS)			% TO ANNUAL
	Females	Males	Total	Females	Males	Total	TARGET
Bulawayo	142	84	226	76	49	125	**22.6%**
Harare	156	137	293	225	224	449	**29.3%**
Manicaland	466	774	1240	240	222	462	**124.0%**
Mashonaland Central	390	492	882	155	140	295	**88.2%**
Mashonaland East	351	369	720	103	103	206	**72.0%**
Mashonaland West	557	521	1078	104	81	185	**107.8%**
Masvingo	861	1055	1916	143	98	241	**191.6%**
Matabeleland North	271	220	491	87	59	146	**49.1%**
Matabeleland South	471	457	928	39	23	62	**92.8%**
Midlands	625	1023	1648	101	91	192	**164.8%**
Grand Total	**4290**	**5132**	**9422**	**1273**	**1090**	**2363**	**94.22%**



Overall, the Commission is fairly contended with its achievement of **94.22%** of its set target for voter registration for the year under review and recommends that resources to conduct outreach programmes in addition to static registration centres be provided for effective results.

Voter Registration Uploading

All provinces uploaded their data, and were able to transfer the majority of the records to the recommended system. However, some records encountered issues during the upload process, necessitating re-uploads and delays in same. Some of the challenges encountered included the following among others, space challenges on the server though this was later resolved through the restoration of the upload and consolidation servers, double registrations where the system did not add to the cumulative total of registrants if a registrant was already in the database as well as challenges to VPN connectivity which led to delays in uploading of data in selected cases.

The table below shows the number of registered voters who were successfully uploaded.

Province	**Voter Population**
BULAWAYO	285
HARARE METROPOLITAN	391
MANICALAND	1 025
MASHONALAND CENTRAL	785
MASHONALAND EAST	458
MASHONALAND WEST	1 083
MASVINGO	1 190
MATABELELAND NORTH	398
MATABELELAND SOUTH	709
MIDLANDS	1 440
TOTAL	**7 764**

The major challenge remained among other things the lack of resources to deploy the ICT teams for proper maintenance at provincial and district offices, leading to inadequate preventative maintenance at these sites as well as insufficient storage capacity, which impacted the efficient handling and management of large volumes of data and optimum virtual server operations.

Performance of the Biometric Voter Registration (BVR) Kits

It has been noted that due to ageing equipment (BVR kits), the effectiveness and efficiency of the system has been decreasing as users encountered some challenges during the course of the year under review. The challenges encountered include among others swollen power banks, failure to charge laptops by solar, failure to upload data and limitation in updating the alpha lists and alignment with the delimitation report of 2022.

Voters' Roll Production and Cleaning

The Commission successfully produced and cleaned all the required voters' rolls for inspection, nomination and for election for each of the by-elections that took place throughout the year 2024. It also received the deceased roll for the period 1st January to 18th December 2024 from the Civil Registry department towards year end and the actual cleaning process had been scheduled for the next financial year.

Alpha List Updating

The provinces and districts kept updating the alpha lists which caused changes as some polling stations were dissolved while others emerged depending on the circumstances. There were many settlement developments taking place in urban centres and some rural growth points and service centres in various districts during the year under review which led to provinces adjusting the polling stations accordingly and in some cases to the creation of new ones. The Commission's provincial and district offices collaborated with local authorities on the relevant information required.

However, there is need to train staff members to further capacitate them on the following among others, the creation of polling stations according to the standard voter registration statistics, management of the deceased roll and the production of an up-to-date voters' roll, which is the most critical requirement for elections to take place.

VOTER EDUCATION

Voter Education for By-elections

The Commission successfully conducted voter education for all by-elections in districts and provinces that had vacant wards and constituencies. As part of strategies aimed at the success of the voter education program, the Secretariat deployed highly mobile teams under the guidance of supervisors allocated with a vehicle to move the teams from one area to the next.



ZEC Voter Educators at Work

This ensured wide and maximum coverage given the five days allocated for the Voter Education for Polling exercise. The teams used mostly hailers to disseminate information at gatherings, across communities, shopping centres and other high traffic areas such as boreholes and community gardening projects.

Gender Sensitivity in Recruitment, Training and Deployment

The Commission ensured gender sensitive recruitment, training and deployment of voter education personnel at all levels. Voter educators were recruited from within the Commission, government and quasi-government departments for purposes of skills and cultural diversity, which enabled voter educators to disseminate polling information in almost all the languages unique to the districts and provinces where elections were held.

The major challenge on voter education was the late payment of allowances for the electoral staff that were deployed without advance payment.

Development of the Chatbot

During the year under review, the Commission developed a new voter education tool called the Chatbot in order to facilitate communication between the organisation and its stakeholders with minimal human interaction. The Chatbot is an interactive platform designed to provide information on the Commission's electoral processes using Artificial Intelligence (AI). It is an innovative voter education tool meant to appeal to the technologically savvy generation of voters who use information and communication technologies.

By the end of the year under review, the Chatbot system was undergoing tests before launch by the Commission.

Partnership with Ministries of Primary, Secondary and Higher Education

The Commission developed a concept on partnering with the Ministry of Primary and Secondary Education, Tertiary Institutions and Universities to conduct voter education and voter registration under the 'catch them young' thrust. Relevant voter education materials for the programme were prepared and produced. The partnership programme was envisaged to be rolled out in the next financial year.

Accreditation of CSOs to conduct Voter Education

The Commission did not accredit any CSOs for purposes of partnering it in voter education programmes and activities since the expiry of their accreditation on the 31st of July 2024.The Commission was awaiting the conclusion of the proposed CSO's Bill.

ELECTIONS

Filling in of Casual Vacancies in 2024

Elective

During the year under review the Commission successfully filled in a total of **101** out of **104** casual vacancies which arose as a result of deaths, recalls and resignations from political parties. The total percentage for the replacement stood at **97.16%.** All elective National Assembly and Local Authority casual vacancies were filled through the conduct of by-elections.



Voters Queue to Vote at a Tent Polling Station

Chiefs

The Commission also conducted Chiefs' by-elections to fill two casual vacancies one in the Senate and the other for a Member of the National Chiefs' Council following the death of Chief Makumbe. However, the absence of specific legal provisions governing the conduct of by-elections to fill vacancies that arise in an Electoral College system caused some challenges.

Party-list and 30% Women's Quota

The Commission also filled in the party-list casual vacancies in the Senate, National Assembly Women's Quota and the 30% Women's Quota for local authority seats during the year under review.

Provincial Council Party- list

The three Provincial Council Party-list vacancies which arose during the year under review were yet to be filled by the time of compilation of this report owing to the fact that the Commission had not received formal notification on the said vacancies.

The affected political parties namely CCC and ZANU PF had written to the Commission to have the vacancies filled. However, the major constraint for the Commission remained the non- alignment of the Electoral Act to the Constitution.

Below is a table summary of the casual vacancies that were filled by 31st December, 2024.

Ser	Type of Election	Filled Vacancies	Unfilled in Vacancies	F	M
1	National Assembly : Elective	6	0	0	6
2	Local Authority	35	0	8	27
3	National Assembly (Women's Quota)	12	0	0	12
4	Senate : Party-List	16	0	7	9
5	30% Women's Quota for Local Authority	30	0	30	0
6	Senate Chief : Elective	1	0	0	1
7	Member of the National Council of Chiefs : Elective	1	0	0	1
8	Provincial Council : Party-list		3		
9	**Total**	**101**	**3**	**45**	**56**

Election Residue Disposal

The Commission disposed election residue for the 2023 Harmonized Elections totaling **103** tonnes earning revenue amounting to **USD4 950.00** in the process. However, by the end of the year under review the remaining seven tonnes were still to be disposed owing to a breakdown of the contractor's equipment.

Green Revolution

The Commission made strides in environmental protection through embracing the green revolution by minimizing the use of carbon emission equipment and adopting solar-based energy systems. Polling Stations were powered by solar energy during the by-elections conducted during the year under review. More resources are still required to reach full integration of solar energy for all future electoral activities The Commission continued to reduce the use of generators, candles and matches.

Donated Mobile Toilets

The Commission received donated mobile toilets for use in elections after the 2023 Harmonized Elections. However, the toilets have proved to be not user-friendly as they do not have adequate gadgetry inside and need more adaptation.

Challenges

The major challenges faced by the Commission during the year under review included the following among others:

- challenges in publishing election notices in national and community newspapers circulating in areas where by-elections were scheduled to be conducted.
- non-payment of election allowances to some recruited electoral officers also negatively impacted on the Commission's image. By the time of compilation of this report some electoral officers were yet to receive their election allowances for the Harmonized and by-elections conducted in 2023 and 2024 respectively.
- numerous litigations pertaining to contested nomination court results which affected the preparation and conduct of by-elections.
- delay by the electoral courts to make decisions on some cases which impacted on the preparations for same.
- the legal lacuna on the filling of provincial council party list vacancies.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Alignment of the Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] to the Constitution
- Alignment of the Electoral Act to Cyber Act [*Chapter 2:13*] to Cyber and Data Protection Act [*Chapter 12:07*]
- Consideration of registration of Political parties to enable enforcement or administration of Code of Conduct for Political Parties and Candidates
- Consideration of time limits for litigations after nomination courts

CONCLUSION

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission wishes to express its gratitude to the Government of Zimbabwe and all stakeholders for the support it received during the course of the 2024 financial year. It also assures all its stakeholders that it remains committed to the fulfilment of its constitutional mandate.

ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

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